SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

11 November 2024 · Shift 3

75 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 15 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 12 questions

Q.1

Two trains start at the same time from two stations and travel towards each other with speeds of 72 km/h and 84 km/h, respectively. When they cross each other, it is found that one train has covered 108 km more than the other. What is the distance (in km) between the two stations, and after how many hours will they meet, respectively?

(A) 1440; 10
(B) 1244; 8
(C) 1404; 9
(D) 1084; 7

Q.2

The sum of three consecutive odd numbers is 58 more than the average of these numbers. Find the largest number.

(A) 33
(B) 37
(C) 27
(D) 31

Q.4

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2000 as a sum borrowed at 8% per year rate of interest for 5 years.

(A) 740
(B) 760
(C) 800
(D) 840

Q.5

A solid sphere of radius 9 cm is melted to form a hollow, right circular cylindrical tube of length 12 cm and external radius 15 cm. The thickness (in cm) of the tube is:

(A) 4
(B) 2
(C) 3
(D) 1

Q.8

The ratio between the monthly incomes of P and Q is 7 : 6 and the ratio between their expenditures is 6 : 5. If they save ₹480 each, then find P’s monthly income.

(A) ₹6,240
(B) ₹2,880
(C) ₹2,400
(D) ₹3,360

Q.9

In an examination, the average marks of the student in class were 85.4. If the student had got 8 more marks in History, 12 more marks in Science, 10 more marks in Computer Science, 15 less marks in Hindi and retained the same marks in other subjects, then the average would have been 87.9. How many subjects were there in the examination?

(A) 5
(B) 7
(C) 6
(D) 8

Q.14

Amar buys a wall clock for ₹300 and sells it for ₹200. Find his percentage loss.

(A) 30.33% loss
(B) 31.33% gain
(C) 32.33% gain
(D) 33.33% loss

Q.15

The average marks of 60 students was found to be 48. Later on, it was discovered that a score of 68 was misread as 56. Find the correct average corresponding to the correct score.

(A) 48.2
(B) 54.2
(C) 44.2
(D) 40.8

Q.16

There are five baskets- A, B, C, D and E. Each basket has rings in it and the average number of rings in all five baskets is 42. If basket D is removed, the average number of rings in the remaining baskets is 38. How many rings are there in basket D?

(A) 42
(B) 64
(C) 58
(D) 38

Q.17

A sum was deposited at a certain rate of simple interest for 4 years. If it had been a 5% higher rate of interest, then it would have amounted to ₹5,200 more. The sum deposited is:

(A) ₹13,000
(B) ₹10,400
(C) ₹25,000
(D) ₹26,000

Q.18

The greatest number which exactly divides the numbers 38, 95 and 171 is:

(A) 19
(B) 13
(C) 21
(D) 9

Q.20

The salary of a person was reduced by 20%. By what percentage should his reduced salary be raised so as to bring it at par with his original salary?

(A) 30%
(B) 22%
(C) 25%
(D) 20%

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 16 questions

Q.2

In a certain code language, ‘BEND’ is written as ‘ADMC’ and ‘FISH’ is written as ‘EHRG’. How will ‘EVIL’ be written in that language?

(A) DWHK
(B) DUJM
(C) DUHK
(D) FWJM

Q.3

E, F, G, H, I, J and K are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). I sits third to the left of J. E is an immediate neighbour of both G and H. G sits third to the right of J. F sits second to the right of I. What is the position of K with respect to H?

(A) Third to the left
(B) Third to the right
(C) Second to the left
(D) Immediate right

Q.5

AI10 is related to YG12 in a certain way. In the same way, BJ20 is related to ZH22. To which of the following is CK30 related, following the same logic?

(A) BC22
(B) BI22
(C) AI32
(D) AB32

Q.6

In a code language, 'MBXL' is coded as 'OXZH' and 'FKRG' is coded as 'HGTC'. How will 'LUGS' be coded in that language?

(A) NQIO
(B) OQJP
(C) NPIN
(D) OPJN

Q.7

6 is related to 77 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 9 is related to 116. To which of the following is 11 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 141
(B) 143
(C) 142
(D) 132

Q.8

In a certain code language, 'KNOW' is coded as '2846' and 'WIDE' is coded as '5729'.What is the code for 'W' in the given code language?

(A) 5
(B) 6
(C) 2
(D) 9

Q.9

Which of the following interchanges of signs would make the given equation correct? 8 – 4 + 144 ÷ 16 × 27 = 14

(A) – and +
(B) + and ×
(C) ÷ and –
(D) × and –

Q.11

OM 13 is related to RP 17 in a certain way. In the same way, WU 19 is related to ZX 23. To which of the following is IG 14 related, following the same logic?

(A) KJ 18
(B) LJ 18
(C) LJ 17
(D) KJ 17

Q.13

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 234 × 6 – 6 ÷ 66 + 60 = ?

(A) 375
(B) 365
(C) 329
(D) 322

Q.14

A, B, L, N, S, T and Z are seven candidates sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order), for a group discussion. L is sitting third to the left of N. N is sitting exactly between T and B. Z is an immediate neighbour of B and is sitting third to the left of S. Z is also an immediate neighbour of A. Who is sitting second to the left of N?

(A) A
(B) S
(C) Z
(D) L

Q.15

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 12, 108; 20, 180

(A) 30, 290
(B) 25, 225
(C) 14, 125
(D) 18, 156

Q.16

Read the given statement(s) and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: All belts are wallets. Some wallets are glasses. Conclusions: (I) Some belts are glasses. (II) Some glasses are not wallets.

(A) Only conclusion I follows.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(C) Only conclusion II follows.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.17

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? FOM, ILJ, LIG, OFD, ?

(A) SCB
(B) RCB
(C) SCA
(D) RCA

Q.18

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 86, 91, 101, 116, ?

(A) 159
(B) 134
(C) 126
(D) 136

Q.19

In a certain code language, ‘FITS’ is coded as ‘ULID’ and ‘GIFT’ is coded as ‘IUZD’. What is the code for ‘G’ in the given code language?

(A) I
(B) Z
(C) D
(D) U

Q.20

Read the given statement(s) and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: Some babies are humans. All babies are animals. Conclusions: (I) At least some animals are humans. (II) All animals are babies.

(A) Only conclusion (I) follows.
(B) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows.
(C) Only conclusion (II) follows.
(D) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow.

General Awareness 23 questions

Q.1

Which of the following national leaders of India inaugurated the first Akhil Bhartiya Kalidas Samman Samaroh held in Ujjain in 1958?

(A) Rajendra Prasad
(B) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(C) Sardar Patel
(D) Jawaharlal Nehru

Q.2

The famous folk dance 'Dholacha Nach' is performed in which state?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Bihar

Q.3

In 2023, the philanthropic organisation Carnegie Corporation of New York placed Ajay Banga, the President of _____, on its annual 'Great Immigrants' list. This list consists of honourees who have enriched and strengthened America and its democracy through their contributions and actions.

(A) European Union
(B) World Bank
(C) Asian Development Bank
(D) African Union

Q.4

Which of the following is/are an example of a non-tax revenue receipt?

(A) Disinvestment
(B) Interest income
(C) External commercial borrowings
(D) Income tax

Q.5

On 11th December 2022, who among the following took over as the Deputy Chief Minister of Himachal Pradesh?

(A) Vikramaditya Singh
(B) Mukesh Agnihotri
(C) Shiv Pratap Shukla
(D) Jairam Thakur

Q.6

The position of the President in the Indian Political system is that of a _____.

(A) Dictator
(B) Real Executive
(C) King
(D) Nominal Executive

Q.7

Who was the Prime Minister when the 11th Fundamental Duty was incorporated into the Indian Constitution?

(A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(B) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(C) Indira Gandhi
(D) Gulzari Lal Nanda

Q.8

The village servants or functionaries, who constituted of groups of families in Vijayanagar empire, were called _____.

(A) nayakas
(B) vellalars
(C) ayagars
(D) amaranayakas

Q.9

The Fourth Anglo-Mysore War was fought in the year _____.

(A) 1799
(B) 1796
(C) 1800
(D) 1797

Q.11
Where is the headquarters of the West Central Railway Zone?

(A) Maligaon
(B) Bilaspur
(C) Hubli
(D) Jabalpur

Q.12
Which team won the first edition of the Women's Premier League (WPL) event in the year 2023?

(A) Gujarat Giants
(B) Mumbai Indians
(C) Delhi Capitals
(D) Royal Challengers Bangalore

Q.13
The Indian Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change maintains a log of all the endangered species of India along with their conservation status. What is the name of this book?

(A) Red Data Book
(B) Indian Life Catalogue
(C) The Black Book
(D) The Book of Endangered Species

Q.14
At which of the following places was the first Singh Sabha founded in 1873?

(A) Lahore
(B) Multan
(C) Jullundur
(D) Amritsar

Q.15
Which of the following festivals is celebrated in the month of Chaitra?

(A) Dussehra
(B) Ramnavami
(C) Janmashtami
(D) Diwali

Q.16
The National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme (NAPS) was launched by the Government of India in the year _____.

(A) 2022
(B) 2005
(C) 2012
(D) 2016

Q.17
Which state lies in the rain shadow region of the Arabian Sea branch of the southwest monsoon?

(A) Goa
(B) Gujarat
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Kerala

Q.18
For which song did Tanvi Shah become the first Indian woman to win a Grammy Award in 2010?

(A) Vande Mataram
(B) Jai Ho
(C) Bharat Ki Beti
(D) Ae Watan

Q.19
What approach did Dadabhai Naoroji use to calculate the Poverty Line?

(A) Export-import data
(B) Agricultural productivity
(C) Prisoner menu
(D) Industrial output

Q.20

Which of the following statements is/are correct temples of Khajuraho? a) Equal importance is given to human experience and spiritual pursuit. b) Jain and Hindu temples are also found at Khajuraho. c) Chausanth Yogini temple is one of the important temples here.

(A) All a, b and c
(B) Only c and a
(C) Only b and c
(D) Only a and b

Q.21

In rat-hole mining, which of the following minerals is mined?

(A) Coal
(B) Bauxite
(C) Gold
(D) Nickel

Q.22

Literal meaning of 'megalith' is _____.

(A) a cave
(B) a big stone
(C) a mortuary
(D) a huge shelter

Q.23

Which of the following Hindi novels is written by Vishnu Prabhakar?

(A) Kyapa
(B) Ardhnarishwar
(C) Vinayak
(D) Mujhe Chand Chahiye

Q.25

Gluten formation is observed in various foods like pasta, noodles, pizzas, and bread. Gluten occurs when two specific proteins are mixed with water. Name the two proteins responsible for gluten formation.

(A) Glutenin and Albumin
(B) Glutenin and Glycine
(C) Glutenin and Gliadin
(D) Glutenin and Casein

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Effective “responses of climate change” are imperative to protect the world’s children and fulfil their rights.

(A) responses with climate change
(B) responses at climate change
(C) responses to climate change
(D) responses from climate change

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank . The company's decision to relocate had a negative _____ on its employees.

(A) accommodation
(B) conclusion
(C) effect
(D) establish

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Always keep in mind leaner bodies need more calories than “fattest” ones.

(A) the fattest
(B) fat
(C) more fatter
(D) fatter

Q.4

Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. We often go camping, but I have never been to that “particular part of town or country” before.

(A) neck of the woods
(B) get it in the neck
(C) risk one's neck
(D) knock on wood

Q.5

Select the sentence that has a grammatical error.

(A) They have an information about the event.
(B) She is an artist at a local gallery.
(C) Can you bring me the keys to the car?
(D) The cat is sleeping on a mat.

Q.6

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined word. The old library had a “musty” smell from years of neglect.

(A) fresh
(B) foggy
(C) stale
(D) casual

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. I have “never had” and never will be dependent on him.

(A) never has
(B) was never being
(C) has never been
(D) never been

Q.8

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Brave

(A) Earthly
(B) Dim
(C) Cowardly
(D) Boundless

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. I did not like his “bossy” attitude.

(A) controlling
(B) sensible
(C) benevolent
(D) idiosyncratic

Q.10

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word from the given sentence. The kitten's playful behaivor brought joy to the entire family.

(A) Joy
(B) Kitten's
(C) Behaivor
(D) Playful

Q.11

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom from the alternatives. Rajiv will understand some day that all his friends are “fair weather friends”.

(A) A friend who stays only when times are convenient
(B) Friends generally have similar characteristics
(C) A friend who meets you only during pleasant weather
(D) True friends help you when you need them

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. When we _____ ourselves, we activate a variety of psychological processes that help us achieve our objectives and improve our overall well-being.

(A) believe in
(B) doubt
(C) demolish
(D) linger

Q.14

Select the option that rectifies the INCORRECT spelling in the given sentence. If you try to conwince people that money is not very important, then you are barking up the wrong tree.

(A) conveence
(B) convincee
(C) canvince
(D) convince

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Collapse

(A) Jump
(B) Surprise
(C) Side
(D) Fall

Q.16

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. If the players don't wear sunscreen, / their faces will / get reddest.

(A) No error
(B) get reddest
(C) If the players don't wear sunscreen,
(D) their faces will

Q.17

Select the correct spelling from the given options to fill in the blank. We _____ to keep you informed of any delay to your expected delivery date.

(A) endevor
(B) endevour
(C) endavour
(D) endeavour

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. compassionate

(A) confident
(B) disciplined
(C) hardworking
(D) cruel

Q.19

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. If I wrote an email / to my boss now, / he will react / by yelling at me tomorrow in the morning.

(A) If I wrote an email
(B) he will react
(C) by yelling at me tomorrow in the morning.
(D) to my boss now,

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Rahul was angry "of" his brother as he broke his pen.

(A) of
(B) on
(C) at
(D) from

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the contemporary times, sports and games are emerging as one of the brightest careers. It expects to ___1___ at a very high moral plane. It demands honesty and transparency. Sports further demand continuous practice, hard work and ___2___ training. One must understand that sport not only has physical benefits but also ___3___ concentration and inner strength. Not only this, one who plays feels that ____4___ overall personality has undergone a change for better. Besides, social connectivity or networking, games develop ___5___ spirit in players.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) decide
(B) dwell
(C) desynchronise
(D) operate

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the contemporary times, sports and games are emerging as one of the brightest careers. It expects to ___1___ at a very high moral plane. It demands honesty and transparency. Sports further demand continuous practice, hard work and ___2___ training. One must understand that sport not only has physical benefits but also ___3___ concentration and inner strength. Not only this, one who plays feels that ____4___ overall personality has undergone a change for better. Besides, social connectivity or networking, games develop ___5___ spirit in players.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) paltry
(B) relentless
(C) abated
(D) faltering

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the contemporary times, sports and games are emerging as one of the brightest careers. It expects to ___1___ at a very high moral plane. It demands honesty and transparency. Sports further demand continuous practice, hard work and ___2___ training. One must understand that sport not only has physical benefits but also ___3___ concentration and inner strength. Not only this, one who plays feels that ____4___ overall personality has undergone a change for better. Besides, social connectivity or networking, games develop ___5___ spirit in players.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) underlines
(B) boosts
(C) controls
(D) deteriorates

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the contemporary times, sports and games are emerging as one of the brightest careers. It expects to ___1___ at a very high moral plane. It demands honesty and transparency. Sports further demand continuous practice, hard work and ___2___ training. One must understand that sport not only has physical benefits but also ___3___ concentration and inner strength. Not only this, one who plays feels that ____4___ overall personality has undergone a change for better. Besides, social connectivity or networking, games develop ___5___ spirit in players.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) their
(B) it's
(C) one's
(D) his

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the contemporary times, sports and games are emerging as one of the brightest careers. It expects to ___1___ at a very high moral plane. It demands honesty and transparency. Sports further demand continuous practice, hard work and ___2___ training. One must understand that sport not only has physical benefits but also ___3___ concentration and inner strength. Not only this, one who plays feels that ____4___ overall personality has undergone a change for better. Besides, social connectivity or networking, games develop ___5___ spirit in players.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) captaincy

(B) sportsmanship

(C) companionship

(D) leadership

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (C) 1404; 9

Each hour the faster train covers 84 − 72 = 12 km more, so they meet after 108/12 = 9 hours. Distance = (72 + 84) × 9 = 156 × 9 = 1404 km.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 31

With the numbers x − 2, x and x + 2, the sum is 3x and the average x: 3x = x + 58, so x = 29 and the largest is 31.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 800

SI = 2000 × 8 × 5/100 = ₹800.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 3

The volume is unchanged: $(4/3)\pi \times 9^3 = 972\pi = \pi(15^2 - r^2) \times 12$, so $225 - r^2 = 81$ and the inner radius r = 12 cm. Thickness = 15 − 12 = 3 cm.

Q.8 · Answer (D) ₹3,360

With incomes 7x and 6x and expenditures 6y and 5y: 7x − 6y = 480 and 6x − 5y = 480. Then 35x − 30y = 2400 and 36x − 30y = 2880, so x = 480 and P's income = 7 × 480 = ₹3,360.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 6

The total would rise by 8 + 12 + 10 − 15 = 15 marks and the average by 87.9 − 85.4 = 2.5, so there were 15/2.5 = 6 subjects.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 33.33% loss

Loss = ₹100 on a cost of ₹300: 100/300 × 100 = 33.33% loss.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 48.2

The total was 68 − 56 = 12 marks short, so the average rises by 12/60 = 0.2: 48 + 0.2 = 48.2.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 58

All five baskets hold 5 × 42 = 210 rings and the other four 4 × 38 = 152, so D has 210 − 152 = 58.

Q.17 · Answer (D) ₹26,000

5% more a year for 4 years is 20% of the sum: 20% = ₹5,200, so the sum is ₹26,000.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 19

38 = 2 × 19, 95 = 5 × 19 and 171 = 9 × 19, so the HCF is 19.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 25%

A salary of 100 falls to 80; raising 80 back to 100 needs 20/80 × 100 = 25%.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.2 · Answer (C) DUHK

Each letter moves one place back: B → A, E → D, N → M, D → C. So EVIL → DUHK.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Third to the left

I is third to J's left and G third to J's right, so they sit side by side; E takes G's other side, with H beyond it, and F is second to I's right. Going round to the left from J: J, F, K, I, G, E, H. Counting left from H: J, F, K, so K is third to the left of H.

Q.5 · Answer (C) AI32

Both letters move 2 places back and the number rises by 2: A → Y, I → G, 10 → 12. So C → A, K → I and 30 → 32: AI32.

Q.6 · Answer (A) NQIO

The letters move +2, −4, +2, −4: M → O, B → X, X → Z, L → H. So L → N, U → Q, G → I, S → O: NQIO.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 142
The number is multiplied by 13 and 1 taken away: 6 × 13 – 1 = 77 and 9 × 13 – 1 = 116. So 11 × 13 – 1 = 142.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 2
W is the only letter in both words and 2 the only digit in both codes, so W = 2.

Q.9 · Answer (D) × and –
Interchanging × and –: 8 × 4 + 144 ÷ 16 – 27 = 32 + 9 – 27 = 14.

Q.11 · Answer (B) LJ 18
Both letters move 3 places forward and the number rises by 4: O → R, M → P, 13 → 17. So I → L, G → J and 14 → 18: LJ 18.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 375
After interchanging the signs: 234 ÷ 6 + 6 × 66 – 60 = 39 + 396 – 60 = 375.

Q.14 · Answer (B) S
With B on N's left, Z would sit beside B and S would need T's seat; so B is on N's right. Going round to the left from N: N, T, S, L, A, Z, B. Second to the left of N is S.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 25, 225
The second number is 9 times the first: 12 × 9 = 108 and 20 × 9 = 180. Likewise 25 × 9 = 225.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
The wallets that are glasses need not be belts, so I does not follow; and every glass may be a wallet, so II does not follow either.

Q.17 · Answer (D) RCA
First letters move 3 forward (F, I, L, O, R), second letters 3 back (O, L, I, F, C) and third letters 3 back (M, J, G, D, A): RCA.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 136
The differences grow by 5: +5, +10, +15, +20. 116 + 20 = 136.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Z
F, I and T are in both words, and U, I and D in both codes. The letter left in GIFT is G and the code letter left in IUZD is Z (in FITS they are S and L), so G = Z.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Only conclusion (I) follows.
The babies who are humans are also animals, so some animals are humans (I). Nothing says every animal is a baby, so II does not follow.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Rajendra Prasad
The first Akhil Bharatiya Kalidas Samaroh at Ujjain, in 1958, was inaugurated by President Rajendra Prasad; Jawaharlal Nehru opened the next year's.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Maharashtra
SSC's key gives Maharashtra; 'Dholacha Nach' is Marathi for 'dance of the dhol', the drum.

Q.3 · Answer (B) World Bank
Ajay Banga became President of the World Bank in June 2023, and was named on Carnegie's 'Great Immigrants' list that year.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Interest income
Interest the government earns is a non-tax revenue receipt. Disinvestment and borrowings are capital receipts, and income tax is tax revenue.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Mukesh Agnihotri
Mukesh Agnihotri was sworn in as Deputy Chief Minister of Himachal Pradesh on 11 December 2022, with Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu as Chief Minister.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Nominal Executive
The President is the nominal (constitutional) head; real executive power lies with the Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
The 11th Fundamental Duty, Article 51A(k) (education for children of 6 to 14), was added by the 86th Amendment in 2002, when Atal Bihari Vajpayee was Prime Minister.

Q.8 · Answer (C) ayagars
In the Vijayanagara empire the hereditary village servants and functionaries were the ayagars.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 1799
The Fourth Anglo-Mysore War was fought in 1799; Tipu Sultan was killed defending Seringapatam.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Jabalpur
The West Central Railway zone has its headquarters at Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Mumbai Indians
Mumbai Indians won the first Women's Premier League in 2023, beating Delhi Capitals in the final.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Red Data Book
The Red Data Book records endangered plants and animals; the IUCN keeps the global one, and India keeps its own for Indian species.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Amritsar
The first Singh Sabha was founded at Amritsar in 1873; the Lahore Singh Sabha followed in 1879.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Ramnavami
Ram Navami, Rama's birthday, falls on the ninth day of the bright half of Chaitra.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 2016
The National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme was launched in August 2016 to encourage apprenticeship training.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Tamil Nadu
The Tamil Nadu coast stays fairly dry in the southwest monsoon: it lies in the rain shadow of the Arabian Sea branch, beyond the Western Ghats.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Jai Ho
Tanvi Shah shared the 2010 Grammy for 'Jai Ho' from 'Slumdog Millionaire', the first Indian woman to win one.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Prisoner menu
Dadabhai Naoroji based his poverty line on the cost of the subsistence diet given to prisoners in jails, the 'jail cost of living'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) All a, b and c
Khajuraho's Chandela temples include both Hindu and Jain temples, among them the Chausath Yogini temple, and their sculpture gives worldly life a place beside the spiritual. All three statements are correct.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Coal
Rat-hole mining digs narrow tunnels to reach thin coal seams, as in Meghalaya.

Q.22 · Answer (B) a big stone
'Megalith' comes from the Greek 'megas' (big) and 'lithos' (stone): a big stone, as used to mark burials.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Ardhnarishwar
Vishnu Prabhakar's novel 'Ardhnarishwar' won him the Sahitya Akademi Award. 'Kyapa' ('Kyap') is Manohar Shyam Joshi's and 'Mujhe Chand Chahiye' Surendra Verma's.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Glutenin and Gliadin
Gluten forms when the wheat proteins glutenin and gliadin are mixed with water.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) responses to climate change
A 'response' is made 'to' something: 'responses to climate change'.

Q.2 · Answer (C) effect
A decision has an 'effect on' people: 'a negative effect on its employees'.

Q.3 · Answer (D) fatter
A comparison with 'than' takes the comparative: 'more calories than fatter ones'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) neck of the woods
One's 'neck of the woods' is a particular area or neighbourhood.

Q.5 · Answer (A) They have an information about the event.
'Information' is uncountable and takes no 'an': 'They have information about the event.'

Q.6 · Answer (C) stale
A 'musty' smell is a damp, 'stale' one.

Q.7 · Answer (D) never been
Each verb must fit 'dependent on him': 'I have never been and never will be dependent on him.' 'Have never had ... dependent' does not work.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Cowardly
The opposite of 'brave' is 'cowardly'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) controlling
'Bossy' means fond of giving orders: 'controlling'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Behaivor
The correct spelling is 'behaviour' ('behavior' in American English).

Q.11 · Answer (A) A friend who stays only when times are convenient
A 'fair-weather friend' stays only while things go well and leaves in hard times.

Q.13 · Answer (A) believe in
To 'believe in' ourselves, to have self-confidence, is what helps us achieve our objectives; the other words do not fit.

Q.14 · Answer (D) convince
The correct spelling is 'convince'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Fall
To 'collapse' is to fall down suddenly: 'fall'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) get reddest
Nothing is being compared, so the superlative 'reddest' is wrong: 'their faces will get red'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) endeavour
The correct spelling is 'endeavour' ('endeavor' in American English).

Q.18 · Answer (D) cruel
'Compassionate' means feeling for others' suffering; its opposite is 'cruel'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) If I wrote an email
SSC's key gives 'If I wrote an email': with 'he will react' in the main clause, the first conditional needs the present, 'If I write an email to my boss now, he will react ...'. (Keeping 'wrote' and changing 'will' to 'would' would also make the sentence correct, so 'he will react' is arguable.)

Q.20 · Answer (C) at
One is 'angry at' (or 'with') a person, not 'angry of'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) operate
Sport is expected to 'operate', that is to work, at a very high moral plane.

Q.22 · Answer (B) relentless
Continuous practice, hard work and 'relentless', that is unceasing, training; 'paltry', 'abated' and 'faltering' would weaken it.

Q.23 · Answer (B) boosts
Besides its physical benefits, sport 'boosts' concentration and inner strength.

Q.24 · Answer (C) one's
The subject is the generic 'one', so the possessive is 'one's': 'one who plays feels that one's overall personality has undergone a change'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) sportsmanship
Games develop the spirit of 'sportsmanship', fair play, in keeping with the passage's stress on honesty and a high moral plane.

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